

A Strategic Analysis of the Customer Acquisition Channels for a Fashion Accessories Franchise

BUSINESS DATA MANAGEMENT - CAPSTONE PROJECT

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Declaration Statement

I am working on a Project Title “A Strategic Analysis of the Customer Acquisition Channels for a Fashion Accessories Franchise”.
I extend my appreciation to [Difa Franchise], for providing the necessary resources that enabled me to conduct my project.

I hereby assert that the data presented and assessed in this project report is genuine and precise to the utmost extent of my knowledge and capabilities. The data has been gathered through primary sources and carefully analyzed to assure its reliability.

Additionally, I affirm that all procedures employed for the purpose of data collection and analysis have been duly explained in this report. The outcomes and inferences derived from the data are an accurate depiction of the findings acquired through thorough analytical procedures.

I am dedicated to adhering to the information of academic honesty and integrity, and I am receptive to any additional examination or validation of the data contained in this project report.

I understand that the execution of this project is intended for individual completion and is not to be undertaken collectively. I thus affirm that I am not engaged in any form of collaboration with other individuals, and that all the work undertaken has been solely conducted by me. In the event that plagiarism is detected in the report at any stage of the project's completion, I am fully aware and prepared to accept disciplinary measures imposed by the relevant authority.

I agree that all the recommendations are business-specific and limited to this project exclusively, and cannot be utilized for any other purpose with an IIT Madras tag. I understand that IIT Madras does not endorse this.

Signature of Candidate: 

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Date: 13/10/25

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Executive Summary

A Strategic Analysis of the Customer Acquisition Channels for a Fashion Accessories Franchise

This project focuses on Difa, a B2C women's accessories franchise located in Velachery, Chennai, operating on a Franchise Owned, Franchise Operated (FOFO) model.
The business aims to provide affordable fashion accessories to a diverse local demographic but faces significant challenges with limited customer reach and an unoptimized marketing strategy, resulting in low returns on advertising expenditure.

To address these problems, this project will conduct a comprehensive market analysis using exclusively public, online data. The problem-solving approach involves a three-pronged strategy: competitive benchmarking of digital footprints(Google Business Profile, social media), sentiment analysis of customer reviews to understand public perception, and identifying hyper-local marketing opportunities. The analysis will be performed using tools like web scrapers and Microsoft Excel to process and visualize the findings.

The expected outcome is a strategic roadmap for Difa. It will include a competitive analysis report, data-driven customer personas for targeted marketing, and a set of actionable recommendations to optimize its digital presence. This will empower the owner to make informed decisions to increase brand visibility, attract more customers, and improve marketing ROI without needing a large budget.

Organization Background:

Difa is a B2C women's accessories brand specializing in affordable handbags, fashion jewellery, makeup, and perfumes. This project focuses on the Velachery, Chennai franchise, which was established in March 2025 and is operated by Mrs. Sridevi under a Franchise Owned, Franchise Operated (FOFO) model, generating an annual turnover of approximately ₹40 lakhs.

Located on a one-way traffic road, the store serves a diverse local demographic of office workers, families, and college students. It operates daily with a team of eight employees, facing local competition within an 800-meter radius.

Vision of the firm: "To provide valuable, low-priced fashion accessories to females of all ages under one roof."

Problem Statement

The business problems that could be identified from the discussion are as follows:

1.To identify the most effective digital customer acquisition channels by analyzing Difa's online presence against its local competitors..
2.To provide a data-backed strategy for an optimized, low-cost marketing plan focused on channels that attract high-value local customers.

Background of the problem

The business challenges faced by the Difa franchise are rooted in the difficulties of a new, single-unit enterprise attempting to establish a market presence in a competitive local environment. As a recently launched store, its major obstacle is a lack of brand awareness within the Velachery demographic.

Internal problems: The core internal issue is the lack of a dedicated marketing team or data analysis framework. Decisions regarding advertising are likely based on intuition rather than data, leading to inefficient allocation of a limited budget. Without tools to measure the effectiveness of different channels, the owner cannot determine which efforts successfully drive footfall versus those that are ineffective.

External problems: Externally, Difa faces direct competition from established local players who may already have a loyal customer base and awareness. The store's marketing messages may be lost in the noise of a busy commercial area. The problem is not just about spending money on ads, but about reaching the right audience (office workers, students) on the right platforms with a compelling message that differentiates Difa from its rivals.

Problem Solving Approach

To address Difa's challenges of limited customer reach and inefficient marketing, this project will implement a strategic problem-solving approach based exclusively on publicly available online data. The methodology involves a comprehensive analysis of Difa's digital presence in relation to its local competitors and target audience.

Methods and Analytical Techniques:

1.Digital Footprint and Competitive Benchmarking:

- Google Business Profile Analysis: I will analyze Difa's Google Maps listing to assess its visibility and customer perception. This includes performing sentiment analysis on customer reviews to identify common themes and analyzing customer engagement.
- Social Media Performance Analysis: The official social media profiles of Difa and its key local competitors will be analyzed to benchmark performance. Key metrics will include follower count, content strategy, post frequency, and public engagement rates.

2.Target Audience and Opportunity Analysis:

- Audience Persona Development: By analyzing the language in reviews and social media comments in the competitor and Difa profile, I will develop data-driven personas for Difa's target customer segments.
- Local Opportunity Mapping: I will use online sources to identify local events and seasonal occasions in Velachery to recommend a hyper-local marketing calendar or stratergies.

Intended Data: The analysis will be based on data collected from online sources, including:

- Google Maps Data: Customer reviews, ratings, and business information for Difa and its competitors.
- Social Media Data: Public posts, follower counts, and engagement metrics from Difa's and competitors' social media pages.
- Influencer Collaboration Data: Observational data on the impact of any public influencer marketing posts.
- Local Search Data: Analysis of search engine results for relevant local keywords.

Tools for Analysis:

- Data Collection: Instant Data Scraper to gather customer reviews and StarNgage to analyze social media engagement metrics.
- Data Analysis and Visualization: All collected data will be organized, analyzed, and visualized using Microsoft Excel.

Expected Outcome

- The primary outcome of this project will be a comprehensive strategic guide for Difa to enhance its local market penetration and optimize its digital marketing efforts. The key deliverables will be:
- A Competitive Digital Benchmark Report: This report will provide a clear, data-backed comparison of Difa's online performance (Google visibility, social media engagement, customer sentiment) against its key local competitors, highlighting specific areas of strength and weakness.
- Data-Driven Customer Personas: Based on the analysis of online reviews and social media interactions, the project will develop 2-3 distinct personas of Difa's target customers in the Velachery area, enabling the owner to create more relevant marketing content.
- An Actionable Hyper-Local Marketing Strategy: The final output will be a set of clear, low-cost recommendations. This will include a content calendar, suggestions for the most effective social media channels to focus on, and a list of local collaboration opportunities to increase brand awareness and drive foot traffic.

Expected Timeline **Gantt chart link:**

